

Negin Farhadi

C R E A T I V E S T R A T E G I S T

rassvyeta@gmail.com · +1 (647) 891-4630 · Toronto, Ontario

rassvyet.squarespace.com

P R O F I L E

I notice problems and build things around them. I built a social platform to address loneliness and disconnection on campus during Covid; I directed a student film to critique the ableism inherent in modern day educational institutions. The creative medium changes, but the strategic instinct doesn't.

With a specialist background in Philosophy and Psychoanalysis at the University of Toronto, I am drawn to the questions underneath the questions: why people think what they think, how culture shapes desire before desire becomes conscious, and what social truths brands are actually responding to through their creative campaigns. That instinct is cultural before it is strategic; formed across three continents, three languages, and various social registers – each one a world that had to be learned in order to live in.

APG Canada member, writer, cultural enthusiast. Strategy is not something I do; it is how I am oriented towards the world.

P R O F E S S I O N A L E X P E R I E N C E

Brand Strategist ZSI Group · Santa Barbara, CA (September 2025 – Present)

- ★ Repositioned brand identity for a private security firm serving the live-events market; rewrote all public-facing copy, shifting register from generic corporate to operationally specific and credible
- ★ Designed and executed a multi-channel candidate acquisition campaign across Meta, LinkedIn, and Indeed; built targeting parameters, ad creative, and a conditional intake funnel that generated 60+ qualified applications and more than doubled staff capacity in a single cycle
- ★ Produced client communications, onboarding materials, and marketing collateral calibrated to distinct audiences: corporate event clients, production companies, and prospective hires
- ★ Advised on outreach strategy and developed print and digital collateral including brochures, logo direction, and advertising materials

Operations Support Santa Barbara International Film Festival · Santa Barbara, CA (January – May 2025)

- ★ Designed an alternative perimeter-control strategy using volunteers during acute staffing and equipment shortages; maintained secure ingress and egress across the full festival run with zero safety incidents
- ★ Coordinated in real time across production, law enforcement, and security personnel under conditions of continuous operational change; engagement extended into an ongoing consulting contract with ZSI Group following festival completion

Front of House Toronto International Film Festival · Toronto, ON (August – September 2025)

- ★ First point of contact for hundreds of daily attendees at Scotiabank Theatre, TIFF's largest venue; managed patron flow, volunteer briefings, and real-time contingency responses across a 14-day deployment at a festival welcoming over 760,000 visitors
- ★ Acted as de facto venue liaison across multiple shifts, resolving security and customer service incidents in real time, filing incident reports, and ensuring every screening started on time; drew on prior security experience to contain a significant incident without disruption to festival operations

Junior Production Coordinator Skin & Bones Film Production · Toronto, ON (July 2025)

- ★ Managed production documentation workflows across concurrent shoots: scheduling, location agreements, and regulatory compliance materials
- ★ Drafted cross-border compliance and logistics documentation for international directors, coordinating across legal, creative, and administrative workstreams in fast-turnaround environments

Associate Producer Under One Sky (Documentary) (2026)

- ★ Co-authored competitive grant applications to the Ontario Arts Council and Canada Council for the Arts; produced formal funding narratives requiring cultural framing, strategic argumentation, and institutional register
- ★ Coordinated pre-production and post-production scheduling, stakeholder communication, and deliverable tracking throughout the project lifecycle

CREATIVE WORK

Strategy Case Studies Independent

- ★ **Lululemon** — Repositioned menswear around serious fitness optimisers who spend thousands on supplements and performance tech while tolerating uncomfortable gear as an accepted condition of training; the strategy makes that blind spot visible and frames lululemon's friction-proof fabric as the variable they never considered.
- ★ **Spotify** — Platform strategy making the case for Spotify as the superior podcast destination for intentional listeners who treat podcast time as a protected mental *sanctuary*; the tension being that YouTube's engagement-maximising architecture actively undermines the deep-listening state they arrived in.
- ★ **Nespresso** — Heritage and origin strategy positioning coffee provenance as a portal to ancestral memory and diasporic identity; developed for second- and third-generation Canadians from coffee-growing regions who use food and drink rituals as their most intimate form of cultural *continuity*.

Director — Content (2023) Short Film

- ★ Wrote and directed *Content* (2023), a horror short screened at the University of Toronto examining the university as a capitalist institution that instrumentalises its students; coordinated all creative and logistical decisions from concept through wrap. Grade: 90%

NIICII — Founder & Product Lead University of Toronto Startup Incubator (2022 – 2023)

- ★ Founded a social discovery platform addressing campus loneliness and social fragmentation; assembled and coordinated an engineering team, taught myself programming fundamentals to lead development credibly; pitched at Next 36 and UofT Hatchery
- ★ Produced market research, competitive analysis, and formal pitch materials for incubator review processes

EDUCATION

Honours Bachelor of Arts, Philosophy Specialist — GPA 3.5 University of Toronto (2025)

- ★ Advanced coursework in epistemology, phenomenology, symbolic logic, and statistics

Community Manager | The Hub UTSC University of Toronto

- ★ Oversaw organisational social media presence and developed programming strategies that measurably expanded active membership and community engagement

Founding Team Member | Hatchery Entrepreneurship Programme University of Toronto

- ★ Engaged with mentor networks, venture design workshops, and peer incubator cohorts; developing entrepreneurial and project management competencies

TOOLS & LANGUAGES

DESIGN & PROTOTYPING

Figma, Framer, Webflow, Canva, Photoshop

RESEARCH & INSIGHT

Qual and quant methods; survey design and analysis; audience segmentation; consumer insight frameworks, Maze, Typeform, G4A, SQL

AI & GENERATIVE

Claude, ChatGPT, Adobe Firefly, Midjourney, Perplexity

LANGUAGES

English, Farsi (native); Danish (fluent); Spanish (beginner)